INTERNATIONAL UNIVERSITY OF APPLIED SCIENCES

PROJECT REPORT

Tasks for Course: DLMBPDDT02 – Design Thinking

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1. TASKS

Design thinking is an effective method for developing new products and services. The focus of the approach is the user and their needs but also their personality, expectations, and habits. From a design-thinking viewpoint, a good solution is one that is profitable, feasible, and desirable. This project report should describe concisely the application of the design thinking process. The three perspectives of desirability, profitability, and feasibility should guide the work along with all the phases.

You are free to choose your favorite approach (Field Guide to Human-Centered Design, d.School, HPI). The choice should be motivated. Furthermore, the adopted design thinking tools in each phase should be described and presented.

Finding an idea or a topic is an important part of the design thinking process. Therefore, in this document, no topic is proposed. You should use your own creativity, sensibility, interests, hobbies, personal experience, and knowledge to develop ideas. You should apply proper design thinking techniques to find suitable topics and identify the related tasks to perform it. But please remember that design thinking is a user-centric approach. People are always the focus; the focus is initially on understanding the user problem.

Please choose one of the following tasks to work on in your project report.

Note on copyright and plagiarism:

Please take note that IU Internationale Hochschule GmbH holds the copyright to the examination tasks. We expressly object to the publication of tasks on third-party platforms. In the event of a violation, IU Internationale Hochschule is entitled to injunctive relief. We would like to point out that every submitted written assignment is checked using plagiarism software. We therefore suggest not to share solutions under any circumstances, as this may give rise to the suspicion of plagiarism.

1.1 Task 1: Design Thinking based on the Field Guide to Human-Centered Design approach

Background: The “Field Guide to Human-Centered Design” from IDEO (https://www.ideo.org) articulates the design thinking process in the following phases: Inspiration, Ideation, and Implementation.

Task: You can develop a new product, a new service, a new process, or even a completely new business model of your choice as part of your design thinking project. You could also improve an existing product, service, process, or business model. Describe an iterative design thinking process based on the "Field Guide to Human-Centered Design" within the framework of a topic of your choice. This approach will move you through three main phases: inspiration, ideation, and implementation. By going through these three phases in sequence, you will develop a deep understanding of the groups and individuals you design for, and you will find out how to integrate what you have learned into an opportunity and a new solution. You will also develop and test your ideas.

Introductory Literature:

IDEO.org. (2015). *The Field Guide to Human-Centered Design. A step-by-step guide that will get you solving problems like a designer.*
http://www.designkit.org/resources/1

1.2 Task 2: Design Thinking based on the d.School approach

Background: The design thinking process proposed by the d.School at Stanford defines the following phases: Empathize, Define, Ideate, Prototype, Test.

Task: You can develop a new product, a new service, a new process or even a completely new business model of your choice as part of your design thinking project. You could also improve an existing product, service, process, or business model. Describe an iterative design thinking process based on the "d.School " within the framework of a topic of your choice. This approach will move you through five main phases: Empathize, Define, Ideate, Prototype, Test. By going through these five phases in sequence, you will develop a deep understanding of the groups and individuals you design for, and you will find out how to integrate what you have learned into an opportunity and a new solution. You will also develop and test your ideas.

Introductory Literature:

Friss, R. (2022). *The 5 Stages in the Design Thinking Process*. *Interaction Design Foundation.* https://www.interaction-design.org/literature/article/5-stages-in-the-design-thinking-process

1.3 Task 3: Design Thinking based on the HPI approach

Background: The design thinking process proposed in the Hasso-Plattner Institute HPI micro-cycle includes six phases: Understand, Observe, Synthesize/Define Point of view, Ideate, Prototype, Test. The first three phases are focused on defining the design challenge, while the remaining three phases are focused on solving the design problem.

Task: You can develop a new product, a new service, a new process or even a completely new business model of your choice as part of your design thinking project. You could also improve an existing product, service, process, or business model. Describe an iterative design thinking process based on the HPI approach within the framework of a topic of your choice. This approach will move you through six main phases: Understand, Observe, Synthesize/Define Point of view, Ideate, Prototype, Test. By going through these six phases in sequence, you will develop a deep understanding of the groups and individuals you design for, and you will find out how to integrate what you have learned into an opportunity and a new solution. You will also develop and test your ideas.

Introductory Literature:

Lewrick, M., Link, P., Leifer, L. J., & Langensand, N. (2018). *The design thinking playbook: mindful digital transformation of teams, products, services, businesses, and ecosystems.* John Wiley & Sons.

2. ADDITIONAL INFORMATION FOR THE EVALUATION OF THE PROJECT REPORT

When conceptualizing and writing the project report, the evaluation criteria and explanations given in the writing guidelines should be considered.

3. TUTORIAL SUPPORT

In this Project Report task, several support channels are open; as the student, it is your responsibility to select your preferred support channel. The tutor is available for technical consultations and for formal and general questions regarding the procedure for processing the Project Report. However, the tutor is not required to approve outlines or parts of texts and drafts. Independent preparation is part of the examination work and is included in the overall evaluation. However, general editing tips and instructions are given in order to help you get started with the Project Report.